TechWiz Privacy & Data Protection Policy

Last Updated: January 2025

At TechWiz Electronics, we take your privacy seriously. This policy explains how we collect, use, store, and protect your personal information in compliance with the UK General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018.

Information We Collect

Information You Provide Directly

When you shop with us, create an account, or contact customer service, we collect:

- **Personal Details**: Name, email address, phone number, date of birth
- **Delivery Information**: Shipping and billing addresses
- **Payment Information**: Credit/debit card details (securely processed by our payment provider)
- **Account Credentials**: Username, password (encrypted)
- **Communication**: Chat logs, emails, phone call recordings (with notice)
- **Product Reviews**: Your name, review text, and rating

Information Collected Automatically

When you visit our website or use our mobile app:

- **Device Information**: IP address, browser type, operating system
- **Cookies**: See our Cookie Policy below
- **Usage Data**: Pages visited, products viewed, search queries
- **Location Data**: Approximate location based on IP address (not precise GPS)

Information from Third Parties

- **Payment Processors**: Transaction confirmation and fraud prevention data
- **Social Media**: If you sign in using Facebook or Google, we receive basic profile information
- **Credit Reference Agencies**: For business accounts and finance applications only

How We Use Your Information

We use your personal data for the following purposes:

Order Processing and Fulfillment

- Process and deliver your orders
- Send order confirmations and shipping updates
- Handle returns, refunds, and warranty claims
- Prevent fraud and unauthorized transactions

Customer Service

- Respond to your inquiries and support requests
- Provide technical support and troubleshooting
- Process warranty claims
- Resolve complaints

Marketing Communications (With Your Consent)

- Send promotional emails about new products, sales, and special offers
- Personalized product recommendations based on browsing and purchase history
- Exclusive loyalty program updates and rewards
- Newsletter with tech news and tips

You can opt out at any time using the unsubscribe link in emails or through your account settings.

Website and Service Improvement

- Analyze website usage to improve user experience
- A/B testing of features and layouts
- Monitor and fix technical issues
- Enhance security and prevent abuse

Legal and Compliance

- Comply with legal obligations and regulations
- Respond to legal requests from authorities
- Enforce our terms and conditions
- Protect our rights and property

Legal Basis for Processing

Under GDPR, we process your data based on:

- **Contract**: Processing necessary to fulfill our contract with you (order processing)
- **Consent**: You've given explicit permission (marketing emails)
- **Legitimate Interest**: Necessary for our business operations (fraud prevention, analytics)
- **Legal Obligation**: Required by law (tax records, warranty claims)

Cookies and Tracking Technologies

We use cookies and similar technologies to enhance your experience.

Essential Cookies (Always Active)

- Shopping cart functionality
- Secure login sessions
- Remember your preferences
- Security and fraud prevention

Analytics Cookies (Can Be Disabled)

- Google Analytics: Track website usage and performance
- Understand how visitors interact with our site
- Identify popular products and pages

Marketing Cookies (Can Be Disabled)

- Personalized advertising on social media and other websites
- Retargeting ads for products you've viewed
- Measure effectiveness of marketing campaigns

Managing Cookies: You can control cookie preferences through our Cookie Settings banner (appears on first visit) or in your browser settings. Note that disabling certain cookies may affect site functionality.

Data Sharing and Third Parties

We **never sell** your personal data. We only share information with trusted partners who help us operate our business:

Service Providers

- **Payment Processors**: Stripe, PayPal (secure payment processing)
- **Shipping Couriers**: Royal Mail, DPD (delivery of orders)
- **Email Service**: Mailchimp (marketing communications)
- **Cloud Hosting**: AWS (secure data storage)
- **Analytics**: Google Analytics (website performance)

All third parties are contractually required to:

- Use data only for specified purposes
- Implement appropriate security measures
- Comply with GDPR and UK data protection laws

Legal Requirements

We may disclose your information if required by:

- Court orders or legal proceedings
- Law enforcement requests
- Protection of our rights and property
- Investigation of fraud or abuse

Business Transfers

If TechWiz is acquired or merged with another company, your data may be transferred to the new owner. You will be notified of any such change.

Data Security

We implement industry-standard security measures to protect your data:

Technical Safeguards

- **Encryption**: All data transmitted using TLS/SSL encryption
- **Secure Servers**: Firewalls, intrusion detection systems
- **Access Controls**: Limited employee access on need-to-know basis
- **Regular Audits**: Security testing and vulnerability assessments

Payment Security

- We are **PCI-DSS Level 1 compliant** (highest security standard)
- Credit card information is never stored on our servers
- Tokenization used for recurring payments
- 3D Secure verification for added protection

Employee Training

All employees undergo data protection training and sign confidentiality agreements.

Note: While we take every precaution, no system is 100% secure. Please use strong passwords and keep your login credentials confidential.

Data Retention

We retain your data for as long as necessary:

Data Type	Retention Period
Account Information	Until account deletion + 30 days
Order History	7 years (tax and legal requirements)
Payment Records	7 years (financial regulations)
Marketing Preferences	Until you opt out + 30 days
Website Analytics	26 months
CCTV (In-Store)	30 days
Customer Service Calls	6 months

After the retention period, data is securely deleted or anonymized.

Your Rights Under GDPR

You have the following rights regarding your personal data:

Right to Access

Request a copy of all personal data we hold about you.

Right to Rectification

Correct any inaccurate or incomplete information.

Right to Erasure ("Right to Be Forgotten")

Request deletion of your data (subject to legal obligations like tax records).

Right to Restriction

Limit how we use your data in certain circumstances.

Right to Data Portability

Receive your data in a structured, machine-readable format.

Right to Object

Object to processing based on legitimate interests or for marketing purposes.

Right to Withdraw Consent

Withdraw consent at any time for marketing communications.

To exercise your rights, contact our Data Protection Officer (see contact details below).

Children's Privacy

TechWiz does not knowingly collect personal information from children under 16 without parental consent. If we discover we've collected data from a child under 16, we will delete it immediately.

Account Deletion

You can delete your TechWiz account at any time:

1. Log into your account
2. Go to "Account Settings"
3. Select "Delete My Account"
4. Confirm deletion

What happens:

- Account and profile information deleted within 30 days
- Order history retained for 7 years (legal requirement)
- Email address retained to prevent re-registration fraud
- Marketing preferences deleted immediately

International Data Transfers

Your data is primarily stored on servers in the United Kingdom. If we transfer data outside the UK/EU:

- We ensure adequate protection through Standard Contractual Clauses
- Only transfer to countries with adequate data protection laws
- You will be informed of such transfers

Marketing Opt-Out

You can opt out of marketing communications at any time:

- Click "Unsubscribe" link in any marketing email
- Log into your account and update Email Preferences
- Email optout@techwiz.co.uk
- Call 0800 123 4567 and request removal

Note: You will still receive transactional emails (order confirmations, shipping updates, account notifications) as these are essential to our service.

Changes to This Policy

We may update this privacy policy from time to time. Changes will be posted on this page with a new "Last Updated" date. For significant changes, we'll send you an email notification.

Contact Us

General Privacy Questions:

- Email: privacy@techwiz.co.uk
- Phone: 0800 123 4567

Data Protection Officer:

- Email: dpo@techwiz.co.uk
- Address: Data Protection Officer, TechWiz Electronics Ltd, 123 High Street, London, EC1A 1BB

Supervisory Authority: If you're unhappy with how we've handled your data, you have the right to lodge a complaint with the UK Information Commissioner's Office (ICO):

- Website: ico.org.uk
- Helpline: 0303 123 1113

Your privacy matters to us. We're committed to transparency and protecting your personal information.